

Gecko Body Signals



What their body and mood are telling you

Body condition, at a glance

Too thin

Thin, tapered tail — low fat reserves

Ideal

Plump, carrot-shaped tail

Overweight

Very wide tail base, sagging

Reading the signals

Happy looks like

- ♥ Calm, curious exploring
- ♥ A relaxed, still tail
- ♥ Regular, healthy sheds
- ♥ Calm basking under the heat source

Stressed looks like

- ♥ Tail waving or vibrating
- ♥ Glass surfing (pacing at the tank walls)
- ♥ Hiding constantly and refusing food
- ♥ Vocal squeaking when handled

A few enrichment ideas

- ♥ Rearranging or adding new tank decor gives them fresh territory to investigate at their own pace
- ♥ Very brief, gentle handling sessions build comfort over time without triggering stress
- ♥ Varying feeder insects encourages natural hunting behavior instead of the same routine every time
- ♥ A consistent day/night light cycle supports healthy natural rhythms and better sleep



Gecko Must-Knows



1

Insects dusted with calcium at most feedings — about 5-8 per feeding for an adult

2

Never feed fireflies — their lucibufagin toxin can be fatal, even in tiny amounts

3

Never grab or hold by the tail — they can drop it as a defense mechanism

4

A healthy tail should look plump, not thin — they store fat reserves there

5

Check the thermostat at every visit — as a cold-blooded reptile, they can't regulate their own body heat

Bonus fun fact

Geckos can voluntarily drop their tail as a defense and regrow a new one, though the replacement looks a bit different.

Loved these? Sprout has so much more.

The Gecko Parent Guide, Sitter Kit & Journal go way deeper — checklists, trackers, keepsakes & more, made just for your gecko.

[See the full collection at georgiekins.com](https://georgiekins.com)



Gecko Emergency & Prep

What to watch for, and how to get ready



Call the vet if you see

- ♥ Sunken eyes or loose, wrinkled skin (dehydration)
- ♥ Not eating for over a week, or a thin/dark tail (fat store depleted)
- ♥ Stuck shed, especially around the toes or tail tip
- ♥ Open-mouth breathing, lethargy, or glass surfing (stress pacing at the glass)

If something risky gets eaten

Call your vet or the ASPCA Animal Poison Control Center:
(888) 426-4435 — available 24/7

